

SUBMISSION REQUIREMENT 3

Cost Breakdown

Development estimate, hosting assumptions, and support model for the application portal in ZAR.

Currency	South African rand (ZAR)
Hosting Assumption	Azure South Africa North
Date	4 May 2026

1. Project Cost Summary

R100k- R130k development estimate	R2.0k- R5.2k monthly hosting range	R250/hr maintenance rate	Separate POPIA advisory sign-off
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The build estimate covers software development of the platform itself. Hosting is a separate monthly cost. POPIA compliance advisory and legal sign-off remain outside development scope and should be handled by the client or an appointed specialist.

2. Development Estimate

Workstream	Estimated Cost	Notes
System setup, architecture, and deployment baseline	R18,000 - R24,000	Application structure, schema, hosting setup, and release configuration.
Applicant portal and submission process	R22,000 - R28,000	Eligibility gate, consent capture, forms, uploads, and submission handling.
Staff dashboard and workflow stages	R30,000 - R40,000	Essay review, academic scoring, document checks, shortlist, interview, and final decision flow.
Scorecard, exports, audit logging, and admin utilities	R18,000 - R24,000	Ranking dashboard, export support, audit trail, and document packaging tools.
Testing, revisions, deployment, and handover	R12,000 - R18,000	Fixes, UAT support, deployment assistance, and project handover.
Total Estimated Development	R100,000 - R130,000	Excluding VAT, monthly hosting, and POPIA advisory services.

3. POPIA Responsibilities

Technical safeguards inside the platform are part of the software build. Formal compliance interpretation, policy drafting, and compliance officer sign-off are separate responsibilities.

Item	Included in Development?	Comment
Audit logging, access control, consent capture, export and deletion support	Yes	Implemented as part of the application.
POPIA policy drafting or legal interpretation	No	Handled outside the development scope.
Compliance officer review and formal sign-off	No	Handled by the client or compliance specialist.

4. Hosting and Support

4.1 Monthly Hosting

Hosting is expected to sit within the following range, depending on whether the final environment is kept at a lightweight demo size or a lean live production size.

Scenario	Monthly Estimate	Typical Shape
Demo or low-volume setup	R2,000 - R2,300	Small app service, small PostgreSQL instance, light storage and monitoring.
Lean live production	R4,200 - R5,200	Standard app service, larger PostgreSQL instance, moderate storage and logging.

These figures are based on current Azure South Africa North pricing checked on 4 May 2026.

4.2 Maintenance and Support

Item	Rate / Period	Notes
Maintenance and support	R250 per hour	Applies to fixes, support, and change requests.
Live application window	1 month	Main period when applicants are submitting.
Post-application support	2 to 3 months	Support for review, issue handling, exports, and closeout activity.

Support is billed only for time used so that post-launch costs remain proportional to the actual level of assistance required.